Lines in register across columns

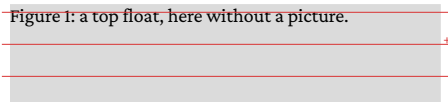

Figure 1: a top float, here without a picture.

A sheet of paper is never quite opaque. When the lines on the back of a leaf fall between the lines on the front, the grey of the far side shows through and the page looks restless. Printers call lines that meet from both sides *in register*.

The same care pays off inside a single page. In two columns the eye moves sideways as well as down, and lines that almost, but not quite, stand level look like a mistake.

Where the error comes from

Running text with one line height keeps its rhythm by itself. A heading of another size breaks it, and so does any margin that is not a whole number of lines. The offset then stays to the foot of the column.

The column beside it knows nothing of this and starts its own count, which is why the two drift apart.

What the grid does

With `line-snap` each line finds the nearest line of a grid that belongs to the page. What is left over goes into the margins around the heading, so it keeps its distance to the text below in proportion.

Line height	Grid
12pt	12pt
15pt	24pt

Tables stay as they are. The first line after one goes back to the grid, and the columns meet again.

A figure at the top of a column moves the text below it by a whole number of lines, so nothing is lost there either.

The same text without line-snap

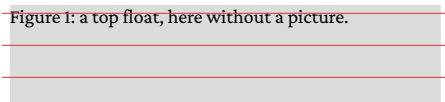

Figure 1: a top float, here without a picture.

A sheet of paper is never quite opaque. When the lines on the back of a leaf fall between the lines on the front, the grey of the far side shows through and the page looks restless. Printers call lines that meet from both sides *in register*.

The same care pays off inside a single page. In two columns the eye moves sideways as well as down, and lines that almost, but not quite, stand level look like a mistake.

Where the error comes from

Running text with one line height keeps its rhythm by itself. A heading of another size breaks it, and so does any margin that is not a whole number of lines. The offset then stays to the foot of the column.

The column beside it knows nothing of this and starts its own count, which is why the two drift apart.

What the grid does

With `line-snap` each line finds the nearest line of a grid that belongs to the page. What is left over goes into the margins around the heading, so it keeps its distance to the text below in proportion.

Line height	Grid
12pt	12pt
15pt	24pt

Tables stay as they are. The first line after one goes back to the grid, and the columns meet again.

A figure at the top of a column moves the text below it by a whole number of lines, so nothing is lost there either.